

Games that are similar to mine usually depend a lot on audible media, especially when it comes to giving the player feedback or creating a certain mood. Things like background music, sound effects for player actions, and audio cues for interacting with objects are considered pretty standard. These sounds help tell the player what's happening without needing extra visuals, and they make the game feel more alive. Because of that, the audio experience is going to be a major focus for me. I want the game to feel more responsive, and good sound design is one of the easiest ways to make even simple interactions such as collecting the keys feel more satisfying and engaging.

Visual media is also really common in games generally including games like mine, and it plays a big part in how polished the final product feels. Improving the character sprites and other art assets will help make the game's style more consistent and appealing. Even small details like cleaner outlines, better colors, or more expressive designs can make a big difference in how the player experiences the world. Animation is another area where upgrades would help a lot. Right now, movements and interactions feel stiff and stale. Smoother animations would make those actions look more natural and help the game feel less stale. I also want to refine the timing of certain animations so they match better with sound effects, since syncing audio and visuals tends to make interactions feel more believable and satisfying.

Two ways to integrate media into my game are directly embedding or loading media at runtime. Direct embedding is basically just putting all the audio, images, and animations right into the project so they're always included in the build. By embedding assets directly into a project, it is incredibly easy, has a builtin engine for optimization and is reliable. The downside is that it increases the build size and makes updates harder after the game is already packaged, but since my project represents only part of the full game, these drawbacks aren't a big issue. Loading media at runtime is the opposite approach and gives more flexibility. Loading media at runtime tends to reduce initial load times and be more flexible when it comes to changing any media. But this method is much more technical and requires a lot of error handling in case something doesn't load correctly. For beginners, it can be harder to manage, and it isn't worth the extra complexity for a project of this size. It also adds more moving parts to the project structure, which could introduce bugs that would take time away from core gameplay improvements.

For the sake of this project, I plan to stick with directly embedding the media. It's faster, easier, and makes sure everything loads right away without extra work. It fits the scope of my game and lets me focus more on improving the audio, visuals, and animations rather than worrying about the loading system. Since this project is more about demonstrating functionality and polish than long-term scalability, prioritizing simplicity makes the most sense.